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Proposed programme budget for 2027

Programme planning

Proposed programme budget for 2027

Part IV

International cooperation for development

Section 15

Human settlements

Programme 12

Human settlements

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* The present document (A/81/6 (Sect. 15)/Part A), consisting of the programme plan and programme performance information (part II; see General Assembly resolution [77/267](#), para. 10), will be replaced by a document containing parts A and B (A/81/6 (Sect. 15)) once part B is issued.

** [A/81/50](#).

*** In keeping with paragraph 10 of General Assembly resolution [77/267](#), the part consisting of the programme plan and programme performance information (part II) is submitted through the Committee for Programme and Coordination for the consideration of the Assembly.



A. Proposed programme plan for 2027 and programme performance in 2025

Overall orientation

Mandates and background

- 15.1 The United Nations Human Settlements Programme (UN-Habitat) is the focal point for sustainable urbanization and human settlements in the United Nations system. It supports Member States in the development of sustainable cities and human settlements through its normative and operational work at the global, regional, national and local levels. UN-Habitat leads and coordinates the monitoring of and reporting on global progress in the implementation of the New Urban Agenda and the achievement of Sustainable Development Goal 11. The mandate derives from the priorities established in relevant General Assembly resolutions and decisions, including resolution [3327 \(XXIX\)](#), by which the Assembly established the United Nations Habitat and Human Settlements Foundation, and resolution [32/162](#), by which the Assembly established the United Nations Centre for Human Settlements (Habitat). The Assembly, through its resolution [56/206](#), transformed the Centre into the United Nations Human Settlements Programme (UN-Habitat), effective 1 January 2002. The Assembly, through its resolution [73/239](#), established a new governance structure for the Programme, consisting of the universal UN-Habitat Assembly, the 36-member Executive Board and the Committee of Permanent Representatives. The UN-Habitat Assembly adopted resolutions providing further guidance on the work of UN-Habitat at its first and second sessions, held in May 2019 and June 2023, respectively.
- 15.2 The Programme's support is aimed at developing the capacity at all levels of government and other key stakeholders to formulate and implement policies, plans and concrete activities for sustainable urban development. Such support is also provided through the implementation of projects under the regular programme of technical cooperation and the United Nations Development Account.

Strategy and external factors for 2027

- 15.3 UN-Habitat operates in a world that will continue to urbanize over the coming three decades. Approximately 90 per cent of urban growth is taking place in less developed regions, where unplanned growth is driving urban sprawl, and where lack of adequate and affordable housing exacerbates poverty and inequalities, which manifest in the rise of informal settlements, slums and homelessness. By contrast, many cities in other parts of the world are facing negative growth and shrinking populations. The global housing challenge is intensifying, with the demand for affordable and adequate housing outpacing supply in urban areas, further deepening inequality and vulnerability. Globally, more than 2.8 billion people live in inadequate housing, a figure that includes over 1.12 billion who reside in slums and informal settlements.¹ Additionally, there are 304 million international migrants,² most of whom live in urban areas, and 75.9 million internally displaced people.³
- 15.4 The proposed programme plan for 2027 is guided by the UN-Habitat strategic plan for 2026–2029, which was approved by the UN-Habitat Assembly in May 2025. The proposed programme structure is informed by the strategic focus and means of implementation. The programme of work centres on access to adequate housing, land and basic services for all, including the transformation of informal settlements and slums to help drive sustainable urbanization. This focus responds directly to the scale and urgency of global housing shortages and recognizes adequate housing as central for

¹ United Nations Human Settlements Programme (UN-Habitat), Global Urban Indicators database (2025).

² See <https://www.migrationdataportal.org/themes/international-migrant-stocks-overview>.

³ See International Organization for Migration, *World Migration Report 2024* (Geneva, 2024) and International Displacement Monitoring Centre, *Global Report on Internal Displacement 2024* (Geneva, 2024).

addressing broader development challenges, including poverty, inequality and vulnerability to the adverse impacts of climate change.

- 15.5 The programme structure distinguishes between the substantive programmatic areas through which UN-Habitat contributes directly to development outcomes and the enabling areas that strengthen the policy, knowledge and partnership ecosystems required to achieve sustainable urban development at scale. This structure also responds to lessons learned from the implementation and midterm evaluation of the previous strategic plan,⁴ which highlighted the need for greater strategic prioritization, clearer programmatic focus and improved coherence across the organization's normative and operational activities.
- 15.6 Subprogramme 1, Housing, land, basic services and urban environment, advances the central focus of the strategic plan on access to adequate housing, land and basic services for all, including the transformation of informal settlements and slums. Through this subprogramme, UN-Habitat will support Member States and local authorities in expanding access to adequate housing and basic services, strengthening land governance and promoting environmentally sustainable urban development, thereby contributing directly to improved living conditions, inclusive prosperity and resilient cities and human settlements.
- 15.7 Subprogramme 2, Planning, finance policy, localization and governance, operationalizes the first two means of implementation identified in the strategic plan, namely, integrated urban and territorial planning, management, investment and finance, and participatory multilevel governance and localization of the Sustainable Development Goals. Through this subprogramme, UN-Habitat will strengthen policy, planning and governance frameworks that enable sustainable urbanization, support the development of integrated planning systems and sustainable urban finance mechanisms and advance participatory governance processes that accelerate the localization and implementation of the Goals.
- 15.8 Subprogramme 3, Knowledge, data, digitalization and capacity development, operationalizes the third means of implementation, with a focus on strengthening knowledge systems and institutional capacities to support evidence-based policymaking and effective implementation of sustainable urban development policies and programmes. Through this subprogramme, UN-Habitat will advance the generation, collection and analysis of urban data and knowledge, promote digital and smart city approaches that support improved urban management and strengthen the capacities of national and local governments and other stakeholders, including monitoring of Sustainable Development Goal 11 and the implementation of the New Urban Agenda.
- 15.9 Subprogramme 4, Partnerships, coalitions, advocacy and communication, a fourth means of implementation, recognizes that achieving impact at scale requires strengthened collaboration among Member States, local and regional governments, international organizations, civil society, academia and the private sector, among others. Through this subprogramme, UN-Habitat will promote strategic partnerships, facilitate global and regional coalitions for sustainable urban development and strengthen advocacy and communication on the importance of adequate housing, land and basic services as drivers of sustainable development. It will also leverage the organization's convening role through global platforms and partnerships to mobilize action, share knowledge and enhance the visibility and impact of sustainable urban development within the broader multilateral system.
- 15.10 Taken together, the four subprogrammes provide a coherent and mutually reinforcing structure that aligns programmatic delivery, enabling policy frameworks, knowledge generation and partnerships in support of the strategic focus of the strategic plan. The structure ensures that UN-Habitat can effectively deliver normative guidance, technical cooperation and knowledge products while mobilizing partnerships and strengthening institutional capacities across levels of government and among stakeholders.

⁴ Office of Internal Oversight Services, "Mid-term Evaluation of the United Nations Human Settlements Programme Strategic Plan 2020–2025" (2024), available at https://unhabitat.org/sites/default/files/2024/04/hsp-eb-2024-4_oios_evaluation_of_un-habitat_strategic_plan_final_report_8april2024.pdf.

- 15.11 The programme of work of UN-Habitat is presented under the new structure, with subprogrammes 1 to 4 of the proposed programme plan for 2026 reorganized and integrated across the new subprogrammes with an annex reporting against programme performance for additional deliverables and results from the proposed programme plan for 2026 (see annex to part A below).
- 15.12 Across regions, subprogramme implementation will be tailored to diverse development contexts – with particular attention to countries in vulnerable and crisis-affected contexts, including least development countries, landlocked developing countries and small island developing States, as well as middle-income and economies in transition – using context-specific thematic entry points and delivery approaches that reflect varying priorities, capacities and pathways to impact under each subprogramme.
- 15.13 Cities are hotspots for environmental challenges, accounting for approximately 75 per cent of global energy consumption, 70 per cent of global greenhouse gas emissions and more than 70 per cent of resource use.⁵ In the Pact for the Future (General Assembly resolution 79/1), Member States reiterated their commitment to ensuring access for all to adequate, safe and affordable housing and supporting developing countries in planning and implementing just, safe, healthy, accessible, resilient and sustainable cities. In that context UN-Habitat will support national, regional and local governments in integrating urban and territorial planning, management, and investment and finance aspects and will support them in developing sustainable construction value chains and policies, supported by innovations and technology, that help to overcome inequalities and build resilience.
- 15.14 The deterioration in progress towards achieving the Sustainable Development Goals and implementing the Paris Agreement in the context of interrelated global crises calls for more transformative multilevel action. UN-Habitat will continue to fast-track integration between its normative and operational work, scaling up and accelerating the impact of the organization. UN-Habitat recognizes that rapid urban growth requires bold, forward-looking and collective action to shape cities in ways that address the most pressing urban challenges. As a global advocate for urban development, UN-Habitat will support countries in navigating complex housing issues, including by supporting the open-ended intergovernmental expert working group on adequate housing for all, by providing evidence-based policy advice, capacity development and technical support, and by driving urban programmes to address complex housing issues.
- 15.15 In line with its capacity-building strategy for the implementation of the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development and the New Urban Agenda, UN-Habitat will continue to localize the Sustainable Development Goals and to respond to local challenges by identifying and targeting specific capacity gaps while raising awareness and building skills in transformative solutions. UN-Habitat will strengthen capacity development as a cross-cutting function across its operations, through the continued digitalization and dissemination of knowledge and tools, supported by strategic partnerships for innovation, knowledge and learning across practices.
- 15.16 In its catalytic role as a knowledge hub and partner convenor, UN-Habitat will carry out advocacy, communication and outreach activities and mobilize broad-based support for the implementation of the New Urban Agenda. It will operationalize stronger stakeholder engagement and collaboration with universities and centres of knowledge and research in order to continue to leverage advocacy and knowledge platforms, including the thirteenth session of the World Urban Forum, the Urban Agenda Platform, coalitions, global corporate events, regional ministerial conferences, the ministerial meeting on urbanization and climate change and the intersessional activities of the open-ended intergovernmental expert working group on adequate housing for all.
- 15.17 Furthermore, UN-Habitat will continue to monitor and report on global trends and provide evidence for policymaking, including through the enhanced use of technologies for data collection and analysis, data visualization and management of information. It will continue to expand the roll-out of the Global Urban Monitoring Framework and its support for Member States and other stakeholders in monitoring and reporting on the progress in the implementation of the New Urban Agenda and other global agendas and the achievement of the Sustainable Development Goals.

⁵ International Energy Agency, *Empowering Urban Energy Transitions: Smart Cities and Smart Grids* (Paris, 2024).

- 15.18 Regarding cooperation with other entities at the global, regional, national and local levels, UN-Habitat will continue its close cooperation with international and regional organizations, such as the Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development, the World Bank, the European Union and regional development banks and explore deepened partnerships with relevant institutions from the global South. UN-Habitat will maintain its focus on partnerships with local authorities and their associations and city networks, grass-roots organizations, foundations, international financial institutions, the private sector and academia to promote participatory and multilevel governance and support municipal efforts in the localization of the Sustainable Development Goals and will continue to serve as the secretariat and co-Chair of the Local2030 coalition.
- 15.19 With regard to inter-agency coordination and liaison, UN-Habitat will continue to collaborate with the United Nations programmes and funds as well as specialized agencies, the Department of Economic and Social Affairs and the United Nations regional economic and social commissions, and strengthen its strategic inter-agency partnerships, building on the United Nations system-wide strategy on sustainable urban development and agency-specific collaborative frameworks. Additionally, UN-Habitat will continue to advance the goals of the United Nations reform aimed at increasing sustainable development impacts at the country level with a focus on regional collaboration achieved through the regional development cooperation platforms and issue-based coalitions. UN-Habitat will also deepen its collaboration with the Development Coordination Office to strengthen the United Nations system-wide impact on sustainable development by providing technical guidance, contributing to the revision of system-wide guidance, helping to build capacity for the use of innovative diagnostic and planning methodologies, and working with the resident coordinator system and United Nations country teams to mainstream sustainable urbanization across common country analyses and United Nations Sustainable Development Cooperation Frameworks.
- 15.20 To pursue stronger integration of environmental, social and economic sustainability and the protection of biodiversity into urban development, UN-Habitat will continue to strengthen its collaboration with the United Nations Environment Programme through the Greener Cities Partnership, in serving as the secretariat for the Secretary-General's Advisory Board of Eminent Persons on Zero Waste and as a partner in the Global Alliance for Buildings and Construction, which is led by the United Nations Environment Programme. UN-Habitat will also lead a new Issue Management Group on Urbanization and the Environment as part of the Environment Management Group; strengthen collaboration with the Special Envoy of the Secretary-General for Road Safety; and continue to collaborate with the Office of the United Nations High Commissioner for Refugees, the United Nations Development Programme, the International Organization for Migration, the United Nations Office for Disaster Risk Reduction, the World Food Programme and all relevant United Nations entities and international actors to integrate sustainable urban development into resilience, humanitarian response, solutions to forced displacement and urban recovery.
- 15.21 With regard to the external factors, the overall plan for 2027 is based on the following planning assumptions:
- (a) Adequate unearmarked extrabudgetary resources are available to implement the planned work and produce the deliverables;
 - (b) Countries remain committed to the New Urban Agenda and the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development;
 - (c) National, regional and local governments continue to request policy advice and technical assistance from UN-Habitat in the development and implementation of their urban legislation, policies, plans and strategies;
 - (d) Urban indicators, data and information are used to formulate policies, with adequate mechanisms available for impact monitoring and performance assessments;
 - (e) Countries in which UN-Habitat delivers large programmes maintain political, economic and social conditions that allow for the implementation of programmes and projects.

- 15.22 UN-Habitat will continue to mainstream social inclusion to address cross-cutting issues affecting women, older persons, persons with disabilities, and children and young people. UN-Habitat will also continue to implement and participate in mechanisms that strengthen the meaningful participation of young people in sustainable urban development, such as the UN-Habitat Youth Advisory Board and the Global Alliance Cities4Children. Furthermore, it will develop critical programmes to promote urban liveability, such as the Youth 2030 Cities programme and the Young Gamechangers initiative.
- 15.23 UN-Habitat integrates a gender perspective into its operational activities, deliverables and results, as appropriate, through its gender policy and action plan. Furthermore, the Advisory Group on Gender Issues advises the Executive Director on how to promote gender equality and women's empowerment in sustainable urban development. UN-Habitat, in collaboration with the United Nations Entity for Gender Equality and the Empowerment of Women (UN-Women), will continue to support Member States with policy, legislation, planning and financing instruments to achieve integrated, inclusive and participatory results. For example, UN-Habitat will continue to promote land and housing policies that incorporate a gender perspective and improve tenure security for all, especially women.
- 15.24 In line with the United Nations Disability Inclusion Strategy, UN-Habitat will continue to work with its partners, including the International Disability Alliance, the Global Disability Fund, World Blind Union, World Enabled and the Global Disability Innovation Hub, to provide support on disability-inclusive urban development. It will develop a dedicated action plan to mainstream disability inclusion across its programmatic work and internal operations, highlighting best practices while identifying critical needs in capacity development and technical assistance. This plan will supplement the established environmental and social safeguards applied to all projects.

Adjustments arising from the UN80 Initiative

- 15.25 The proposed programme plan for 2027 reflects changes arising from the UN80 Initiative; in particular, the tables of deliverables reflect updated deliverables for 2026, in line with the approved programme budget for 2026.
- 15.26 UN-Habitat will be guided by any future decisions taken in the context of the UN80 Initiative, in accordance with the applicable rules and procedures, including decisions, resolutions and established practice of the competent intergovernmental organs.

Legislative mandates

- 15.27 The list below, which was reviewed in the preparation of the proposed programme budget, provides all mandates entrusted to the programme.

General Assembly resolutions

3327 (XXIX)	Establishment of the United Nations Habitat and Human Settlements Foundation	56/206	Strengthening the mandate and status of the Commission on Human Settlements and the status, role and functions of the United Nations Centre for Human Settlements (Habitat)
32/162	Institutional arrangements for international cooperation in the field of human settlements		
34/114	Global report on human settlements and periodic reports on international cooperation and assistance on human settlements	70/1	Transforming our world: the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development
42/146	Realization of the right to adequate housing	71/256	New Urban Agenda
53/242	Report of the Secretary-General on environment and human settlements	73/239	Implementation of the outcomes of the United Nations Conferences on Human Settlements and on Housing and Sustainable Urban Development and strengthening of the United Nations Human Settlements Programme (UN-Habitat)
S-25/2	Declaration on Cities and Other Human Settlements in the New Millennium		

Section 15 Human settlements

76/183	Integrating sport into youth crime prevention and criminal justice strategies	80/142	Ensuring access to affordable, reliable, sustainable and modern energy for all
77/286	World Sustainable Transport Day	80/154	Eradicating rural poverty to implement the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development
78/122	World Cleanup Day		
79/1	The Pact for the Future	80/175	Inclusive policies and programmes to address homelessness, including in the aftermath of the coronavirus disease (COVID-19)
79/214	Implementation of the outcomes of the United Nations Conferences on Human Settlements and on Housing and Sustainable Urban Development and strengthening of the United Nations Human Settlements Programme (UN-Habitat)	80/180	Policies and programmes involving youth
		80/181	Promoting social integration through social inclusion
		80/184	Improvement of the situation of women and girls in rural areas
79/223	Women in development		
79/226	Quadrennial comprehensive policy review of operational activities for development of the United Nations system	80/185	Violence against women migrant workers
		80/207	The right to development

Economic and Social Council resolutions

2020/7	Affordable housing and social protection systems for all to address homelessness	2025/25	Strengthening the United Nations Forum of Mayors
2025/4	Mainstreaming a gender perspective into all policies and programmes in the United Nations system		

UN-Habitat Assembly resolutions and decisions

1/2	United Nations System-Wide Guidelines on Safer Cities and Human Settlements	2/5	Enhancing the interlinkage between urbanization and climate change resilience
1/3	Enhancing capacity-building for the implementation of the New Urban Agenda and the urban dimension of the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development	2/6	Localization of the Sustainable Development Goals
		2/7	Adequate housing for all
1/4	Achieving gender equality through the work of the United Nations Human Settlements Programme to support inclusive, safe, resilient and sustainable cities and human settlements	2/8	Urban planning and sustainable infrastructure
		2/9	Creation of a human settlements resilience framework for early warning, foresight, risk reduction, crisis response and post-crisis recovery and reconstruction
2/1	International guidelines on people-centred smart cities	2/10	Equitable financing and effective monitoring of the implementation of resolutions adopted by the United Nations Habitat Assembly
2/2	Accelerating the transformation of informal settlements and slums by 2030	Decision 2/6	Strategic plan of the United Nations Human Settlements Programme for the period 2026–2029
2/4	Biodiverse and resilient cities: mainstreaming biodiversity and ecosystem services into urban and territorial planning		

United Nations Environment Assembly of the United Nations Environment Programme resolution

5/5	Nature-based solutions for supporting sustainable development
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Executive Board decisions

2025/6	Financial, budgetary and administrative matters of the United Nations Human Settlements Programme; implementation of the strategic plan; work programme and budget for 2026; report on the activities of the Office of Internal Oversight Services and the Ethics Office to the Executive Board
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Committee of Permanent Representatives recommendations

OECPR.2025/7 Outcomes of the third open-ended meeting of the Committee of Permanent Representatives

Governing Council resolutions

21/3	Guidelines on decentralization and strengthening of local authorities	24/2	Strengthening the work of the United Nations Human Settlements Programme on urban basic services
21/10	Strengthening the Habitat and Human Settlements Foundation: experimental financial mechanisms for pro-poor housing and infrastructure	26/9	Human settlements development in the Occupied Palestinian Territory
23/10	Future activities by the United Nations Human Settlements Programme in urban economy and financial mechanisms for urban upgrading, housing and basic services for the urban poor		

Subprogramme 1

Housing, land, basic services and urban environment

General Assembly resolutions

69/213	Role of transport and transit corridors in ensuring international cooperation for sustainable development	79/208	Implementation of the Convention on Biological Diversity and its contribution to sustainable development
76/255	Integration of mainstream bicycling into public transportation systems for sustainable development	80/131	The pivotal role of reliable and stable energy connectivity in driving sustainable development
77/161	Promoting zero-waste initiatives to advance the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development	80/135	Promoting sustainable consumption and production patterns for the implementation of the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development, building on Agenda 21
77/334	Follow-up to the United Nations Conference on the Midterm Comprehensive Review of the Implementation of the Objectives of the International Decade for Action, "Water for Sustainable Development", 2018–2028	80/137	Disaster risk reduction
78/148	Strengthening the links between all modes of transport to achieve the Sustainable Development Goals	80/138	Protection of global climate for present and future generations of humankind
78/290	Improving global road safety	80/139	Implementation of the United Nations Convention to Combat Desertification in Those Countries Experiencing Serious Drought and/or Desertification, particularly in Africa
		80/216	The human rights to safe drinking water and sanitation

Subprogramme 2

Planning, finance policy, localization and governance

UN-Habitat Assembly resolution

1/5 Enhancing urban-rural linkages for sustainable urbanization and human settlements

Governing Council resolutions

23/4	Sustainable urban development through access to quality urban public spaces	25/6	International guidelines on urban and territorial planning
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Subprogramme 3

Knowledge, data, digitalization and capacity development

General Assembly resolutions

34/114	Global report on human settlements and periodic reports on international cooperation and assistance on human settlements	71/313	Work of the Statistical Commission pertaining to the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development
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Section 15	Human settlements		
79/175	The right to privacy in the digital age	80/147	Science, technology and innovation for sustainable development
80/118	Information and communications technologies for sustainable development	80/215	Promotion and protection of human rights in the context of digital technologies
<i>Economic and Social Council resolutions and decisions</i>			
Statistical Commission decision 53/110	Human settlements statistics	2025/19	Science, technology and innovation for development
<i>UN-Habitat Assembly resolution</i>			
1/3	Enhancing capacity-building for the implementation of the New Urban Agenda and the urban dimension of the 2030 Agenda for Sustainable Development		

Deliverables

15.28 Table 15.1 lists all cross-cutting deliverables of the programme.

Table 15.1
Cross-cutting deliverables for the period 2025–2027, by category and subcategory

Category and subcategory	2025 planned	2025 actual	2026 planned	2027 planned
A. Facilitation of the intergovernmental process and expert bodies				
Parliamentary documentation (number of documents)	–	–	2	–
1. Report of the Secretary-General on implementation of the outcome of the United Nations Conference on Housing and Sustainable Urban Development (Habitat III) and strengthening of the United Nations Human Settlements Programme (UN-Habitat)	–	–	1	–
2. Report of the Secretary-General on progress in the implementation of the New Urban Agenda	–	–	1	–
Substantive services for meetings (number of three-hour meetings)	30	30	22	29
Meetings of:				
3. The governing bodies (UN-Habitat Assembly, Executive Board and Committee of Permanent Representatives)	26	27	18	26
4. The Committee for Programme and Coordination	1	1	1	1
5. The Advisory Committee on Administrative and Budgetary Questions	1	1	1	1
6. The Fifth Committee	1	1	1	1
7. The General Assembly on the review of the implementation of the New Urban Agenda	1	–	1	–
B. Generation and transfer of knowledge				
Publications (number of publications)	1	1	1	1
8. UN-Habitat annual report	1	1	1	1
C. Substantive deliverables				
Consultation, advice and advocacy: consultations with all Member States on resolutions of the General Assembly and of the Economic and Social Council; and briefings to all Member States on sustainable development issues and processes.				
D. Communication deliverables				
Outreach programmes, special events and information materials: digital and printed communication materials on UN-Habitat and its flagship initiatives and events, including the Executive Board sessions, the High-level Political Forum, and other strategic events.				
External and media relations: interviews, media engagements and commentaries on UN-Habitat priority thematic areas, including housing, land and basic services, urban climate action, urban crisis response, and shared prosperity; communication materials related to Sustainable Development Goal 11 and local action to advance sustainable cities and communities.				

Category and subcategory	2025 planned	2025 actual	2026 planned	2027 planned
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Digital platforms and multimedia content: online content on adequate housing, land and basic services, urban climate action, urban crisis response and shared prosperity; corporate website, including strategic corporate information; social media content for UN-Habitat corporate channels.

Evaluation activities

- 15.29 Five project and programme evaluations conducted by UN-Habitat relating to the programme cooperation agreement between UN-Habitat and the Swedish International Development Cooperation Agency (for the period 2020–2025), 12 sessions of the World Urban Forum and other topics completed in 2025 have guided the proposed programme plan for 2027.
- 15.30 In response to the results of the above-mentioned evaluations, UN-Habitat has incorporated findings and recommendations from the evaluation of the 12 sessions of the World Urban Forum to feed into the development of the thirteenth session, to be held in 2026 in Baku. The adjustments considered for the thirteenth session of the World Urban Forum include improvements of the venue and logistics, optimization of the World Urban Forum format, size and focus, as well as maximization of the networking and interaction potential of the event, all of which have been considered in the planning of the 2026 session. Moreover, the evaluation of the Programme Cooperation Agreement with the Swedish International Development Cooperation Agency highlighted the need for local ownership and the adaptation of interventions to the local context, which has informed the design of new interventions where UN-Habitat country offices have taken a leading role.
- 15.31 The following evaluations to be conducted by UN-Habitat are planned for 2027:
- (a) A midterm evaluation of the UN-Habitat strategic plan for 2026–2029;
 - (b) One country programme evaluation;
 - (c) One thematic evaluation on gender equality;
 - (d) 19 project and programme evaluations.

Programme of work

Subprogramme 1

Housing, land, basic services and urban environment

Objective

- 15.32 The objective, to which this subprogramme contributes, is to ensure access to adequate housing, land and basic services for all, transforming informal settlements and slums with access to clean, safe, affordable and equitable basic services that lead to the creation of low-carbon, resilient, inclusive, healthy and economically vibrant cities and neighbourhoods.

Strategy

- 15.33 To contribute to the objective, the subprogramme will support Member States in developing solutions to expand access to adequate housing, land and basic services (water, sanitation, mobility, waste management and energy) and to promote climate change adaptation and resilience, urban low-emission development strategies, accessibility and sustainability across the rural-urban continuum, with an emphasis on transforming informal settlements, slums and underserved areas, as well as in crisis-affected contexts. Specifically, the subprogramme will:
- (a) Provide technical assistance to Member States in the aforementioned areas;

- (b) Provide policy advisory services and advocacy in the aforementioned areas;
 - (c) Develop standards, tools and guidelines for local and national governments;
 - (d) Conduct research to inform decision-making on affordable housing and equitable access to basic services;
 - (e) Provide capacity development and institutional support, including the dissemination of learning and best practices.
- 15.34 In doing so, the subprogramme will assist Member States in making progress towards achieving the Sustainable Development Goals, particularly Goals 1, 3, 5–8, 10–11, 13 and 16.
- 15.35 The above-mentioned work is expected to result in:
- (a) Increased access to adequate housing for all, benefiting people in cities and human settlements, particularly those in the poorest and those in vulnerable situations, who are often disproportionately affected by global challenges, such as housing shortages and climate change;
 - (b) Improved and more equitable access to basic services, with a focus on low-carbon and climate-resilient urban basic services, particularly for people living in informal settlements and slums, as well as those living in crisis-affected contexts;
 - (c) Integrated land-use planning and management that supports the social and ecological function of land, with a focus on increasing climate-resilient urban development, especially for the urban poor;
 - (d) More efficient and equitable use of land, including strengthened security of tenure, benefiting communities and households, with a special emphasis on those in vulnerable situations.

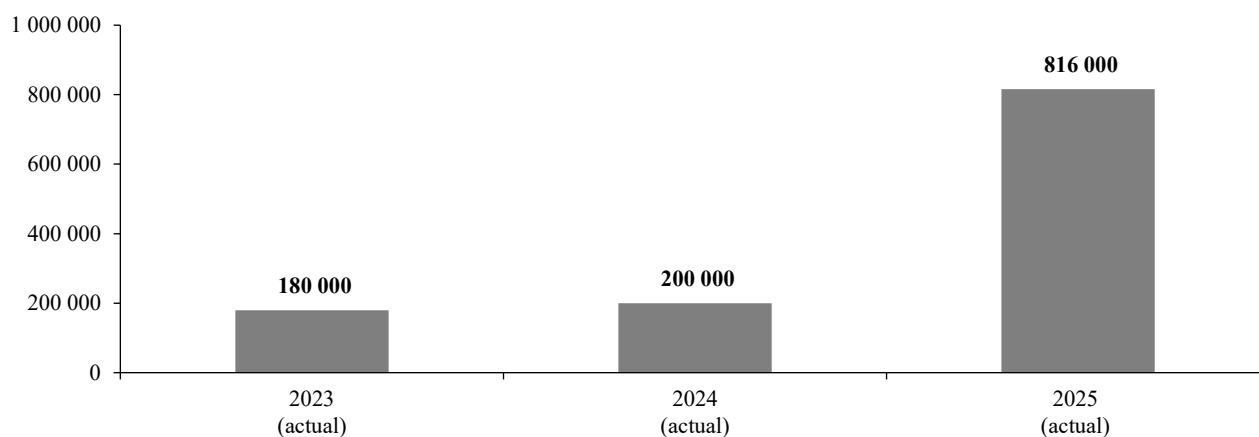
Programme performance in 2025

Integrated sustainable mobility and transit-supportive housing to expand equitable access to safe, equitable public transport in cities, particularly city peripheries

- 15.36 To support access to public transport, especially in city peripheries, which, owing to urban sprawl, is often where low- and middle-income households reside, the subprogramme supported Member States in integrating sustainable mobility and transit-supportive housing to expand access to livelihoods, education and essential services. Sustainable mobility initiatives were implemented in 29 cities across 21 countries, advancing safer, more inclusive and climate-responsive transport systems. Concrete implementation projects – focused on improving pedestrian and cycling infrastructure around public transport corridors and school zones – were carried out in Ethiopia, Ghana, Kenya, Nigeria and Uganda, expanding access to safe, equitable public transport to 816,000 people. This work also contributed to the roll-out of the Pan-African Action Plan for Active Mobility in five countries and supported the expansion of activities to more than 50 cities under the Global Alliance of Cities for Road Safety.
- 15.37 Progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see figure 15.I).

Figure 15.I

Performance measure: number of people with access to safe, equitable public transport (annual, rounded to the nearest 1,000)



Planned results for 2027

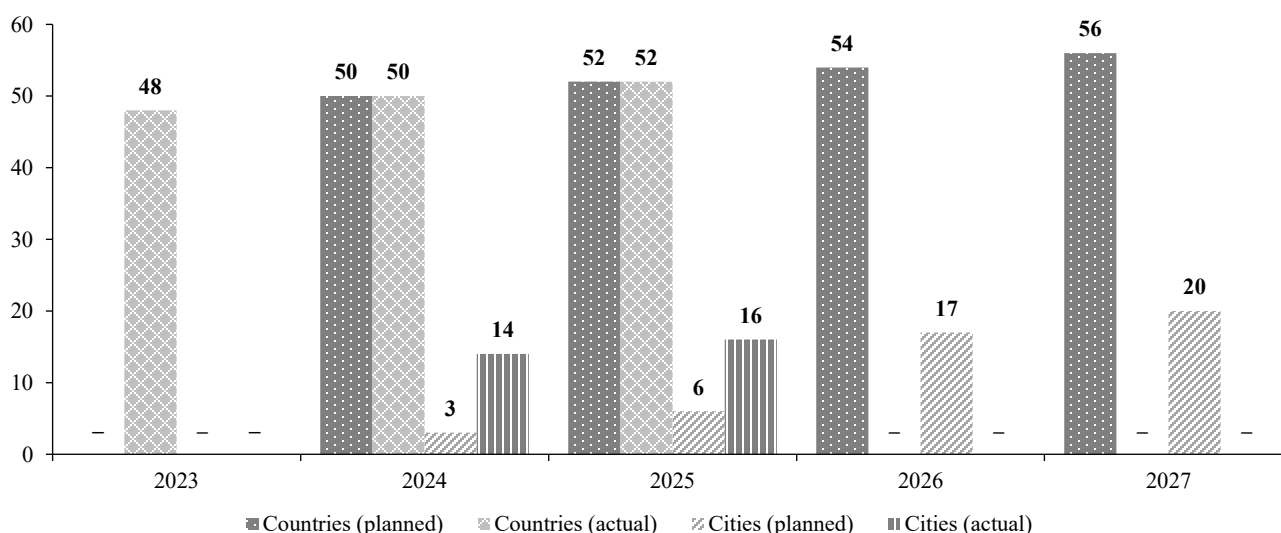
Result 1: cities and countries commit to providing adequate housing for all and addressing homelessness and housing exclusion

Programme performance in 2025 and target for 2027

- 15.38 The subprogramme's work contributed to two additional partner cities (Cancún in Mexico and Trinidad in Cuba) and two additional countries (Costa Rica and the Comoros) for a total of 16 cities and 52 countries, which met the planned target for countries and exceeded the planned target for partner cities.
- 15.39 Progress towards the objective and the target for 2027 are presented in the performance measure below (see figure 15.II).

Figure 15.II

Performance measure: number of partner cities and countries that have adopted strategies towards ending homelessness and ensuring sustainable access to adequate housing for all (cumulative)



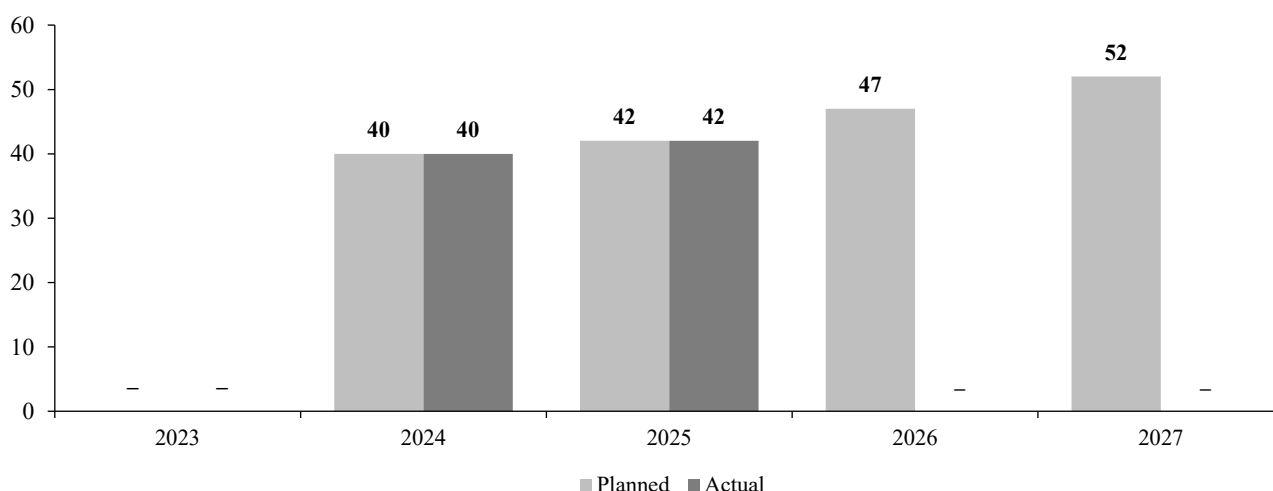
Result 2: increased security of tenure rights to land

Programme performance in 2025 and target for 2027

- 15.40 The subprogramme's work contributed to increased security of tenure through the issuance of land ownership certificates in two additional cities (Gadhawa and Lamahi municipalities in Dang district, Nepal), for a total of 42 cities, which met the planned target.
- 15.41 Progress towards the objective and the target for 2027 are presented in the performance measure below (see figure 15.III).

Figure 15.III

Performance measure: number of partner cities implementing innovative strategies, tools or approaches in order to increase the security of tenure rights to land (cumulative)



Result 3: increased access to adequate housing, land and basic services

Proposed programme plan for 2027

- 15.42 More than 2.8 billion people around the world face some form of housing inadequacy, including 1.1 billion people in informal settlements and slums, which underscores the need to ensure adequate housing and secure land tenure and basic services for all.⁶ The subprogramme provides technical assistance, standards and tools, policy dialogue and capacity-building to Member States to ensure adequate housing, strengthen urban policies and plans, improve land administration and tenure security, transform informal settlements and expand access to basic services, contributing to low-carbon and resilient cities and neighbourhoods.

Lessons learned and planned change

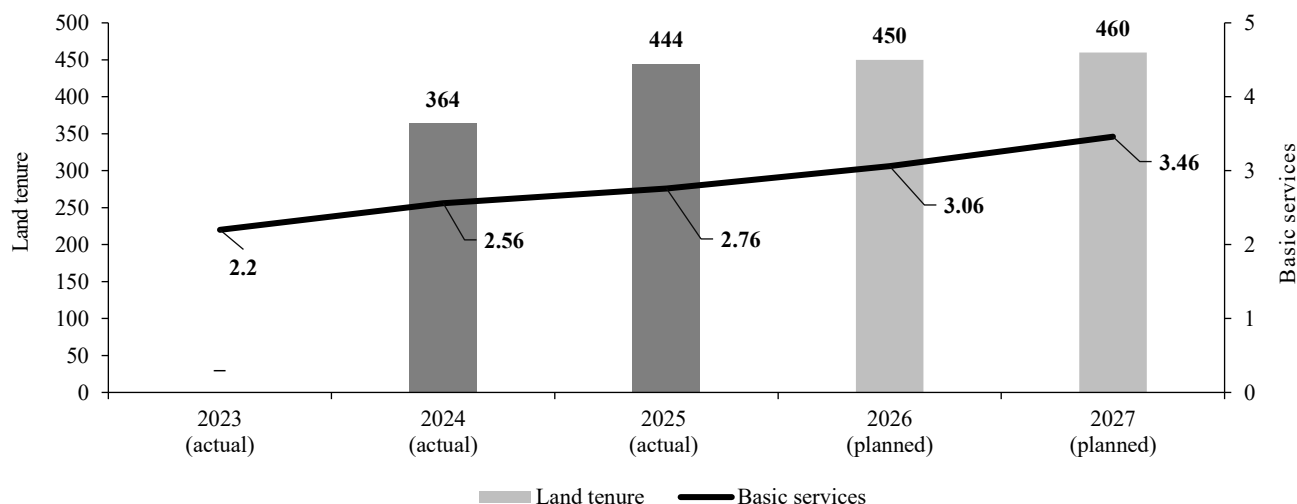
- 15.43 The lesson for the subprogramme was that adopting approaches that recognize and reinforce the interlinkages between housing, land and basic services can provide for synergies and complementarities in implementation. In applying the lesson, the subprogramme will position housing as a driver of sustainable urban development requiring a systems approach that embeds housing in broader socioeconomic and environmental strategies, empowering cities to become inclusive, connected and resilient for all.
- 15.44 Expected progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see figure 15.IV).

⁶ See UN-Habitat "Annual Report for 2024: Adequate Housing for All" (Nairobi, 2025), available from <https://unhabitat.org/annual-report-2024>.

Figure 15.IV

Performance measure: number of people with access to adequate housing,^a land and basic services (cumulative)

(Millions)



^a The methodology and baseline for measuring access to adequate housing is under development. The resulting baseline will inform the planned target for the number of persons with access to adequate housing to be reflected in the proposed programme plan for 2028.

Deliverables

15.45 Table 15.2 lists all deliverables for the subprogramme.

Table 15.2

Subprogramme 1: deliverables for the period 2025–2027, by category and subcategory

Category and subcategory	2025 planned	2025 actual	2026 planned ^a	2027 planned
B. Generation and transfer of knowledge				
Field and technical cooperation projects (number of projects)	32	32	30	71
1. Projects on urban basic services: mobility, water and sanitation, energy and solid waste management	15	15	13 [15]	15
2. Projects on housing, slum upgrading, innovative financing for housing and land readjustment	9	9	9	11
3. Projects on land tenure security, land-based financing and implementation of the Secretary-General's guidance note on land and conflict	6	6	6	7
4. Projects on urban monitoring, evidence-based policies for crime prevention and community safety and social cohesion in cities and human settlements	2	2	2	3
5. Projects on global, national and subnational policies, legal instruments, plans and strategies for climate resilient urban development	—	—	—	10
6. Projects on effective climate change adaptation and mitigation and on addressing loss and damage, as well as the urban environment and biodiversity, with a particular emphasis on the vulnerabilities of the urban poor	—	—	—	25
Seminars, workshops and training events (number of days)	97	97	96	117
7. Training on urban basic services: mobility, water and sanitation, energy and solid waste management	25	25	25	37

Section 15 Human settlements

Category and subcategory	2025 planned	2025 actual	2026 planned ^a	2027 planned
8. Training on slum upgrading, housing, heritage in urban development, regeneration and urban growth, urban design governance, crime prevention and urban safety, and land governance in crisis-affected contexts	14	14	13 [15]	16
9. Global and regional workshops on land, housing, slum upgrading, housing studios and practitioner labs	6	6	6	8
10. Training on land tenure, governance and financing, and workshops on urban land governance	2	2	2	4
11. Training for partners and those in vulnerable situations (e.g., in informal settlements) on climate change mitigation, air quality and low-emission basic services	15	15	15	17
12. Training on effective adaptation of communities and infrastructure to climate change	35	35	35	35
Publications (number of publications)	9	8	9	11
13. Publications on land tenure, governance and land degradation	3	2	3	4
14. Publications on affordable and sustainable housing, including homelessness and slum transformation	2	2	2	4
15. Publications on climate change mitigation and air quality	2	2	2	1
16. Publications on the urban content of nationally determined contributions and on urban nationally determined contribution implementation	–	–	–	1
17. Publications on effective adaptation of slums and other urban communities in vulnerable situations in urban neighbourhoods, and infrastructure, to climate change	2	2	2	1
Technical materials (number of materials)	19	20	19	29
18. Best practices, guides and case studies on increased and equal access to basic services, sustainable mobility and public space	4	5	4	7
19. Guidelines on the right to adequate housing and prevention of homelessness among those in vulnerable situations, including migrants	1	1	1	2
20. Guide series for innovative land, legal and financial mechanisms in relation to conservation and regeneration	1	1	1	2
21. Toolkits, housing profiles and technical guides for city leaders on managing and implementing affordable and sustainable housing and on slum upgrading programmes	3	3	3	4
22. Guides and tools to improve land management and tenure security	2	2	2	4
23. Guidelines and handbooks on slum upgrading solutions	2	2	1	4
24. Technical materials on climate action, basic services or environment in human settlements	2	2	3	2
25. Technical materials on national, regional and local guidelines, plans, coordination mechanisms and strategies on climate action, the urban environment, ecosystems and biodiversity, ecological assets and ecosystem services	2	2	2	2
26. Technical materials on improved low-emission urban services, resource efficiency and (electric) mobility solutions and infrastructure (including monitoring)	2	2	2	2

C. Substantive deliverables

Consultation, advice and advocacy: technical advice to requesting Member States on monitoring and implementation of the New Urban Agenda, the Sustainable Development Goals and UN-Habitat Assembly resolutions.

Databases and substantive digital materials: global knowledge platforms on adequate housing; digital materials on global commitments related to land, housing, urban basic services, mobility, energy, water and sanitation, solid waste management, air quality, climate change mitigation and adaptation and cultural heritage; databases on urban climate- or environment-relevant subjects, and simulations, including a global database on the urban dimension of nationally determined contributions; and e-mobility toolbox supporting the shift to electric mobility; Global Water Operators' Partnerships Alliance-water operators partnerships Observatory; Global Alliance of Cities for Road Safety digital platform.

D. Communication deliverables

Outreach programmes, special events and information: brochures, leaflets and spotlights on slum upgrading, housing, urban land governance and management and urban basic services; brochures, campaigns and events on transforming informal settlements and slums by 2030, greenhouse gas emissions, resource efficiency, protection of ecological assets and effective adaptation of communities and infrastructure to climate change.

External and media relations: media kits, press releases, web stories and social media content on housing, land and urban basic services, and inclusive cities; press articles on climate action and the urban environment.

Category and subcategory	2025 planned	2025 actual	2026 planned ^a	2027 planned
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Digital platforms and multimedia content: multimedia content including video documentaries, infographics, webinars and open digital platforms on basic services, housing, urban safety, heritage, regeneration and urban growth and urban climate - or environment-relevant subjects.

^a Reflects updated planned deliverables for 2026. Values in square brackets represent the number of planned deliverables reflected in A/80/6 (Sect. 15).

Subprogramme 2 Planning, finance policy, localization and governance

Objective

- 15.46 The objective, to which this subprogramme contributes, is to advance integrated urban planning, financing mechanisms, evidence-based policy frameworks, effective legislation and participatory multilevel governance systems for equitable access to adequate housing, land and basic services, taking into consideration the localization of the Sustainable Development Goals and mainstreaming gender equality and women's empowerment.

Strategy

- 15.47 To contribute to the objective, the subprogramme will:
- (a) Provide technical assistance and capacity development to Member States in integrated and gender-sensitive spatial planning, municipal finance, urban policy formulation, legal reforms, Sustainable Development Goals localization and participatory multilevel governance;
 - (b) Facilitate knowledge exchange, peer learning and multi-stakeholder dialogue platforms that connect national, subnational and local governments with civil society, the private sector and development partners;
 - (c) Support the development and implementation of gender-sensitive, normative frameworks, tools and good practice guidance on urban planning systems, innovative financing mechanisms, policy and legislative reforms and participatory multilevel governance;
 - (d) Strengthen monitoring, evaluation and evidence generation on urban development trends, financing flows, policy and legislation effectiveness and multilevel governance outcomes to inform decision-making.
- 15.48 In doing so, the subprogramme will assist Member States in making progress towards achieving the Sustainable Development Goals, particularly Goals 5, 10–11 and 16–17.
- 15.49 The above-mentioned work is expected to result in:
- (a) National and local institutions developing and implementing integrated and gender-sensitive urban planning systems, mobilizing domestic resources, managing public expenditure and coordinating multilevel governance for sustainable urban development;
 - (b) Adoption and implementation of gender-sensitive urban policies, legal frameworks and financing mechanisms aligned with the New Urban Agenda and national development priorities;
 - (c) Increased engagement and ownership by local governments, communities, women, young people and marginalized groups in participatory urban planning, budgeting and decision-making processes;
 - (d) Strengthened alignment between national Sustainable Development Goal targets and local action, with improved tracking and reporting on urban-related indicators at subnational levels.

Programme performance in 2025

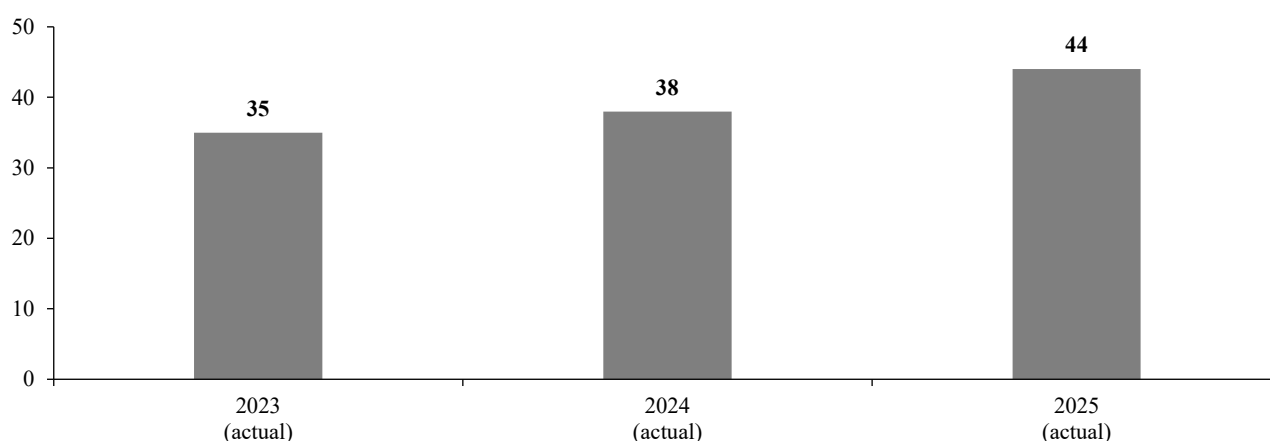
Planning law reforms strengthen multilevel governance for resilient and sustainable cities

- 15.50 Rapid urbanization and climate change are placing growing pressure on cities, exacerbating fragmented planning systems, unclear institutional mandates and weak coordination between national and local authorities. Addressing these challenges is essential to ensure that climate and urban development commitments translate into effective local action. The subprogramme supported Member States through analysis of legal and institutional frameworks, capacity development and comparative research to strengthen urban legislation as a foundation for resilient and sustainable development, focusing on clarifying institutional roles and responsibilities, improving legal coherence and reinforcing multilevel governance. For example, in 2025, stakeholder consultations and a UN-Habitat review of the Zimbabwe Climate Change Management Bill were undertaken to enhance national ownership of the proposed law and ensure broader institutional and community engagement in its implementation. Moreover, in Sierra Leone, the enactment of the Town and Country Planning Act (2025) strengthened decentralized urban governance by empowering local councils to lead spatial planning and development control, enhancing vertical coordination and integrated territorial planning. Also in 2025, Botswana initiated reforms to the 2013 Planning Law, informed by legal gap analyses, international comparative case studies and inclusive stakeholder consultations, modernizing the planning framework with effective governance mechanisms.

- 15.51 Progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see figure 15.V).

Figure 15.V

Performance measure: number of countries undertaking urban legal and governance reforms (cumulative)



Planned results for 2027

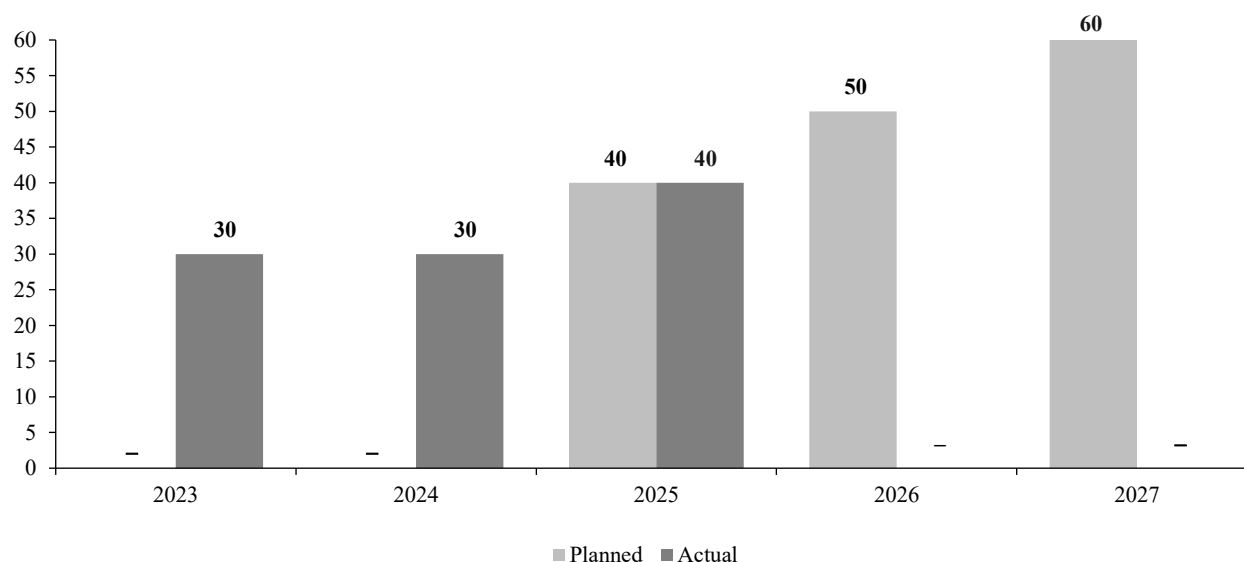
Result 1: upgraded own-source revenue systems to improve the performance of local governments

Programme performance in 2025 and target for 2027

- 15.52 The subprogramme's work contributed to 10 additional local governments, for a total of 40, upgrading their own-source revenue systems to improve revenue collection. For instance, rapid own-source revenue diagnostics were conducted in three Costa Rican municipalities (Palmares, Sarchí and Atenas), identifying gaps in registration, collection and valuation and providing targeted recommendations to improve revenue performance, which met the planned target.
- 15.53 Progress towards the objective and the target for 2027 are presented in the performance measure below (see figure 15.VI).

Figure 15.VI

Performance measure: number of local governments that have developed strategies and reform initiatives to enhance own-source revenue (cumulative)



Result 2: Sustainable Development Goals localization fosters system change and territorial transformation by nurturing inclusive multilevel governance, stakeholder participation, institutional capacities and finance for local solutions

Proposed programme plan for 2027

- 15.54 The subprogramme advances system change and territorial transformation through Sustainable Development Goals localization and multilevel governance, translating global goals and national policies into local action. It supports sustainable urban development by strengthening institutional capacity, mobilizing partners and stakeholders, leveraging finance for local solutions and building the capacities of the United Nations System on Goals localization.

Lessons learned and planned change

- 15.55 The lesson for the subprogramme was that there were further opportunities to advance territorial transformation and the translation of global goals and national policies into local plans and impact through localization and multilevel governance. In applying the lesson, the subprogramme will enhance its guidance and toolkits for Sustainable Development Goals localization, targeting the United Nations System and its partners, to demonstrate in practical terms how to translate global goals into local tangible outcomes. The subprogramme will consolidate technical assistance efforts into integrated support packages and facilitate the use of common methodologies, shared data platforms and coordinated capacity-development approaches. The subprogramme will promote regular knowledge-sharing across regional and global partners and will align its work more systematically with United Nations country teams to ensure coherent system-wide delivery.
- 15.56 Expected progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see table 15.3).

Table 15.3
Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)	2026 (planned)	2027 (planned)
UN-Habitat Assembly adopted resolution 2/6	100 cities joined the Sustainable Development Goals Cities global community	Senegal and Tunisia began implementation of national localization frameworks	50 additional cities join the Sustainable Development Goals Cities global community	Three new countries begin implementation of national Sustainable Development Goals localization frameworks
Local2030 Coalition selected as a high-impact initiative during the Sustainable Development Goals Summit	Local2030 Coalition mobilized a total of \$10 million for localization programmes	80 additional cities joined the Sustainable Development Goals Cities global community	Local2030 Coalition mobilizes a total of \$50 million for localization programmes	Local2030 Coalition mobilizes a total of \$70 million for localization programmes
	5 United Nations entities implemented the Local2030 Coalition workplan	Local2030 Coalition mobilized a total of \$30 million for localization programmes	15 additional United Nations entities implement the Local2030 Coalition workplan	15 additional United Nations entities implement the Local2030 Coalition workplan
		10 additional United Nations entities are actively engaged in implementing the Local2030 Coalition workplan	10 additional United Nations country teams take local action informed by the Local2030 capacity-building programme	20 additional United Nations country teams take local action informed by the Local2030 capacity-building programme

Deliverables

15.57 Table 15.4 lists all deliverables for the subprogramme.

Table 15.4
Subprogramme 2: deliverables for the period 2025–2027, by category and subcategory

Category and subcategory	2025 planned	2025 actual	2026 planned	2027 planned
B. Generation and transfer of knowledge				
Field and technical cooperation projects (number of projects)	19	19	19	21
1. Projects on integrated spatial planning, spatial frameworks, urban planning and design, urban-rural links, integrated territorial development and safe, inclusive and accessible public space	13	13	13	10
2. Projects on spatial productivity, municipal finance, domestic resource mobilization, innovative financing mechanisms, and urban and municipal finance	6	6	6	4
3. Projects on national and local policies, legal and regulatory frameworks, effective urban legislation and governance systems for sustainable urban development	—	—	—	4
4. Projects on Sustainable Development Goals localization, multilevel governance, vertical integration, and participatory governance mechanisms	—	—	—	3

Category and subcategory	2025 planned	2025 actual	2026 planned	2027 planned
Seminars, workshops and training events (number of days)	40	40	40	31
5. Training and seminars on integrated spatial planning connectivity, urban planning and design, metropolitan planning, public space, urban and rural linkages, action planning, urban and territorial planning and national urban policies	26	26	26	10
6. Training on urban productivity, local economic development, municipal finance, domestic resource mobilization, public financial management, fiscal decentralization and innovative financing mechanisms	8	8	8	8
7. Training on legal and governance frameworks, urban legislation, participatory governance and accountability mechanisms	6	6	6	8
8. Training events on Sustainable Development Goals localization, multilevel governance, voluntary local reviews and vertical integration mechanisms	–	–	–	5
Publications (number of publications)	–	–	–	3
9. Publication on urban policy, legislation, metropolitan planning and urban-rural linkages	–	–	–	2
10. Publication on Sustainable Development Goals localization and multilevel governance	–	–	–	1
Technical materials (number of materials)	12	23	12	16
11. Technical materials on integrated spatial planning, urban planning and design, metropolitan planning, urban and rural links, action planning, urban and territorial planning and national urban policies	6	6	6	2
12. Technical materials on spatial productivity, local economic development, municipal finance, domestic resource mobilization and innovative financing mechanisms	3	3	3	1
13. Technical materials on legal and governance frameworks, urban legislation, regulatory reforms and accountability mechanisms	3	14	3	9
14. Technical materials on Sustainable Development Goals localization, voluntary local reviews, multilevel governance and vertical integration frameworks	–	–	–	4
C. Substantive deliverables				
Consultation, advice and advocacy: consultation and advice to approximately 20 Member States on integrated spatial planning, national urban policies, urban-rural linkages, metropolitan development, territorial development, municipal finance, domestic resource mobilization, legal and governance frameworks, Sustainable Development Goals localization and gender-sensitive multilevel governance mechanisms.				
Databases and substantive digital materials: national urban policy database comprising approximately 160 countries; UrbanLex database; global municipal finance database comprising approximately 110 cities; compendium of urban-rural linkage case studies; Sustainable Development Goals localization platform with voluntary local reviews; e-learning courses on urban policy, municipal finance and Sustainable Development Goals Cities.				
D. Communication deliverables				
Outreach programmes, special events and information materials: community of practice, including the Global Network of Public Space; brochures, leaflets, profiles and events on integrated spatial planning, national urban policies, urban-rural linkages, metropolitan development, territorial development, urban monitoring, public space, municipal finance, legal and governance frameworks, Sustainable Development Goals localization and multilevel governance.				
External and media relations: media kits, press releases, web stories and social media content that are inclusive and gender-sensitive.				
Digital platforms and multimedia content: social media content on policy, legal reforms, integrated spatial planning and Sustainable Development Goals localization.				

Subprogramme 3 Knowledge, data, digitalization and capacity development

Objective

- 15.58 The objective, to which this subprogramme contributes, is to advance inclusive, evidence-based and digitally enabled knowledge systems to ensure access to adequate housing, land and basic services.

Strategy

- 15.59 To contribute to the objective, the subprogramme will:
- (a) Generate, synthesize and disseminate policy-relevant knowledge, analytical products and good practices on housing, land and basic services, including through research, global assessments, practical learning tools and policy papers, to support evidence-based decision-making by Member States and stakeholders;
 - (b) Strengthen the collection, harmonization, analysis and use of data and indicators on housing, land and basic services at the global, national and subnational levels, including through the development of monitoring frameworks and tools aligned with international standards, the Sustainable Development Goals and the New Urban Agenda;
 - (c) Promote the use of digital solutions and frontier technologies to improve data availability, accessibility and transparency and support innovative approaches, platforms and strategies for planning, monitoring and delivery of housing, land and basic services;
 - (d) Build institutional and technical capacities of Member States and other stakeholders for the formulation, implementation and monitoring of inclusive housing, land and basic services policies and programmes, including through higher and professional education, training and digital learning, as well as peer learning and co-creation.
- 15.60 In doing so, the subprogramme will assist Member States in making progress towards achieving the Sustainable Development Goals, particularly Goals 1, 4, 6, 9, 11 and 17.
- 15.61 The above-mentioned work is expected to result in:
- (a) Increased access to quality knowledge and data to inform housing, land and basic services policies and practice at the global, national and subnational levels;
 - (b) Increased adoption of digital and innovative approaches to policymaking, implementation and monitoring related to housing, land and basic services;
 - (c) Strengthened expertise and institutional capacities of Member States, at all levels, and of stakeholders to design, implement and monitor inclusive and equitable policies for housing, land and basic services.

Programme performance in 2025

Urban practitioners have open access to practical knowledge and guidance in multiple languages to help accelerate the implementation of the New Urban Agenda and the Sustainable Development Goals

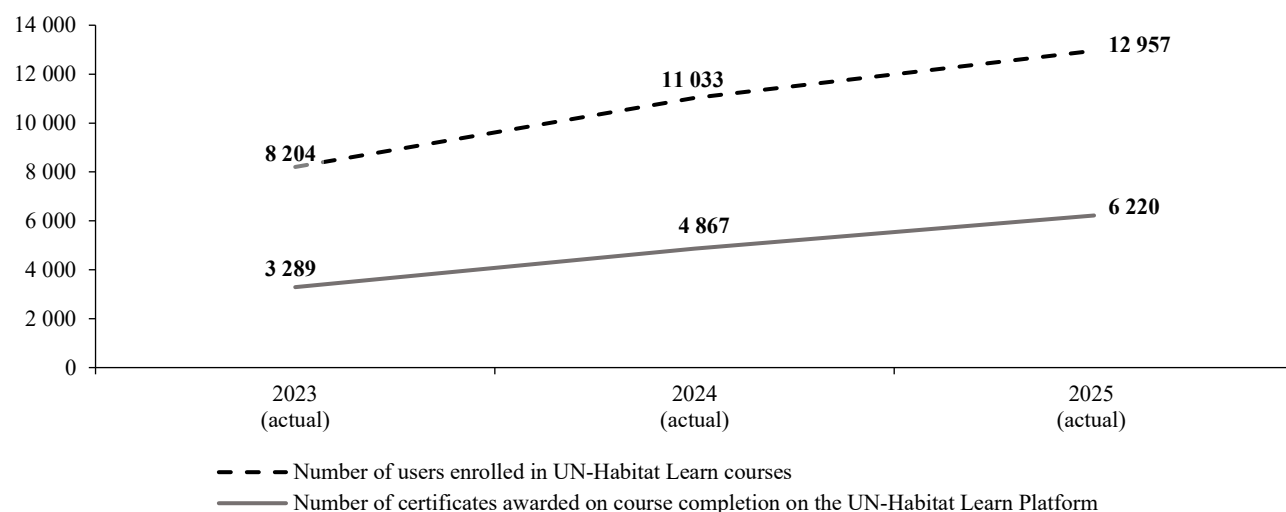
- 15.62 Building the capacities of urban practitioners across the globe with adequate skills, knowledge and tools can be supported by developing and scaling digital learning solutions. The subprogramme leverages the potential of knowledge digitalization to enhance outreach and accessibility of learning on critical skills and capabilities. Starting in 2020, UN-Habitat piloted the creation of its first self-paced online courses based on the New Urban Agenda illustrated handbook. This marked the creation of the UN-Habitat Learn platform and the development of an instructional design function at UN-Habitat. The UN-Habitat Learn platform has helped with both scaling up and localizing the organization's practical knowledge and guidance, with more than 25 different courses to date, providing practical guidance to advance the New Urban Agenda and the Goals, free and accessible to all. The platform offers content in eight languages over 126 hours of learning. It also provides space for digital classrooms supporting hybrid or in-person training programmes. The platform's course offering presents guidance and methodologies illustrating the main findings of normative and operational work, often capitalizing on multi-year, multi-partner and multi-country initiatives. This knowledge is integrated into learning pathways through an iterative co-creation process across

UN-Habitat teams. In some cases, courses have been translated into non-official languages for further replication at the local level.

15.63 Progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see figure 15.VII).

Figure 15.VII

Performance measure: number of students and practitioners enrolled in the UN-Habitat Learn platform and awarded certificates for completion of self-paced online courses (cumulative)



Planned results for 2027

Result 1: digital transformation for sustainable urban development

Programme performance in 2025 and target for 2027

- 15.64 The subprogramme's work contributed to the development and continued dissemination of the UN-Habitat people-centred smart cities approach and associated operational toolkits, which did not meet the planned target of the endorsement by the UN-Habitat Assembly of the international guidelines on people-centred smart cities. The target was not met as there was no intergovernmental agreement reached on the adoption of the international guidelines on people-centred smart cities.
- 15.65 Progress towards the objective and the target for 2027 are presented in the performance measure below (see table 15.5).

Table 15.5

Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)	2026 (planned)	2027 (planned)
UN-Habitat Assembly adopted resolution 2/1 Fifteen cities developed people-centred smart city strategies and plans	Twenty cities piloted strategies, plans and projects to inform the development of the international guidelines on people-centred smart cities	The UN-Habitat Assembly took note of the international guidelines on people-centred smart cities	Ten cities pilot the international guidelines on people-centred smart cities	Ten cities implement people-centred smart city strategies, plans or projects using UN-Habitat approach and toolkits

Result 2: national and local authorities increase and improve the production of disaggregated and policy-relevant data on housing, land and basic services (cumulative)

Proposed programme plan for 2027

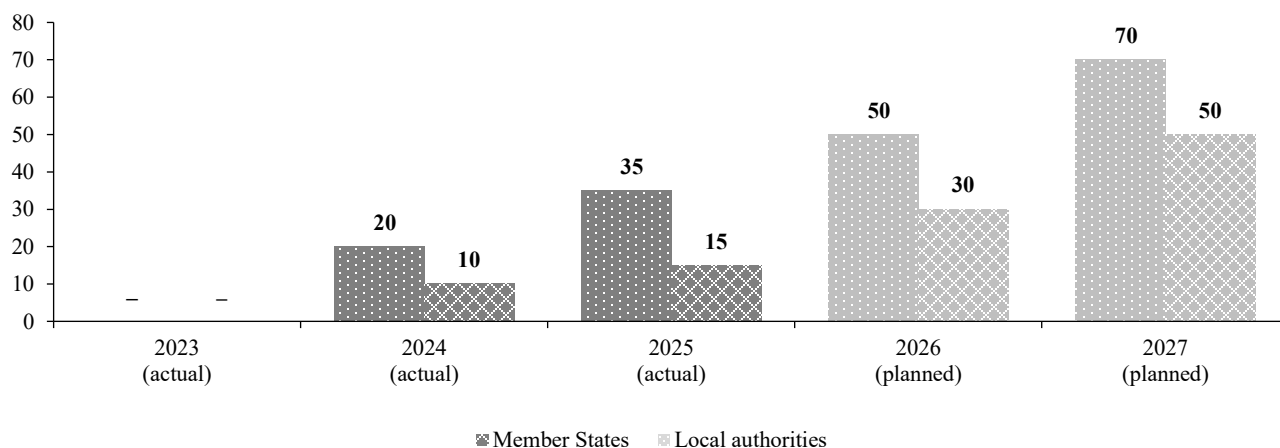
- 15.66 The subprogramme will build on previous work in knowledge generation, data, digital innovation and capacity development towards strengthening national and subnational capacities for Sustainable Development Goals and New Urban Agenda data collection, integration and reporting, expanding the use of geospatial and digital tools and enhancing data-to-policy linkages through targeted analytical products and capacity-building initiatives, in collaboration with national statistical systems and the Global Urban Data Coalition.

Lessons learned and planned change

- 15.67 The lesson for the subprogramme is that, while progress has been made in expanding urban data availability and digital tools, there are opportunities to further strengthen the institutionalization, interoperability and disaggregation of data and databases to help ensure impact on policy development. In applying the lesson, the subprogramme will focus on embedding housing, land and basic services data within national and subnational planning and reporting systems, strengthening coordination across institutions and data sources, and prioritizing equity-focused, disaggregated data approaches aligned with Sustainable Development Goals and New Urban Agenda monitoring and reporting requirements.
- 15.68 Expected progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see figure 15.VIII).

Figure 15.VIII

Performance measure: number of national and local authorities producing disaggregated and policy-relevant data on housing, land and basic services (cumulative)



Deliverables

- 15.69 Table 15.6 lists all deliverables of the subprogramme.

Table 15.6

Subprogramme 3: deliverables for the period 2025–2027, by category and subcategory

Category and subcategory	2025 planned	2025 actual	2026 planned	2027 planned
B. Generation and transfer of knowledge				
Field and technical cooperation projects (number of projects)	—	—	—	8
1. Project on supporting the replication and upscaling of digital tools in additional countries, and providing applied research, spatial analysis and digital support for post-crisis urban recovery and environmental resilience	—	—	—	1
2. Projects on data for housing, slums and informal settlements mapping	—	—	—	2
3. Projects on regional data on Sustainable Development Goal 11 and New Urban Agenda targets	—	—	—	2
4. Projects on implementation of the Global Urban Monitoring Framework and urban observatories	—	—	—	1
5. Projects on capacity development, training centre and learning for sustainable urban development	—	—	—	2
Seminars, workshops and training events (number of days)	5	5	5	46
6. Seminars, workshops and training events on the continued use, adaptation and upscaling of people-centred smart cities tools for local governments, and artificial intelligence tools for Sustainable Development Goal target 11.1 monitoring and informal settlement mapping	—	—	—	5
7. Training workshops for application of the degree of urbanization methodology	—	—	—	4
8. Training and expert group workshops on slums and informal settlements mapping	—	—	—	2
9. Seminars, workshops and training events for regional and local leaders, engaging them on applying global digital cooperation principles in their cities	—	—	—	1
10. Workshop for the development of the <i>World Cities Report</i>	—	—	—	1
11. Technical workshops on monitoring and reporting on the Sustainable Development Goals and the New Urban Agenda	5	5	5	5
12. Seminars, workshops and training events on competency frameworks, technical training for local government workforces and the International Urban Training Centre	—	—	—	28
Publications (number of publications)	—	—	1	2
13. <i>World Cities Report</i>	—	—	1	—
14. Publication on revised methodology for mapping slums and informal settlements	—	—	—	1
15. Applied research report on the use of digital technologies in post-crisis urban recovery contexts	—	—	—	1
Technical materials (number of materials)	—	—	3	8
16. Technical materials to apply digital tools across diverse country contexts	—	—	—	2
17. Technical materials on metadata for Sustainable Development Goals and New Urban Agenda monitoring targets and slums mappings	—	—	—	2
18. Handbook for the application of competency frameworks methodologies for urban practitioners to enhance urban resilience in least developed countries	—	—	—	1
19. Practical self-paced online courses for students and urban practitioners	—	—	3	3

C. Substantive deliverables

Consultation, advice and advocacy: advisory services provided to Member States on the implementation, localization and sustainability of digital tools and artificial intelligence methodologies, and on data production for adequate housing including slums and informal settlements mapping; coordinated engagement and partnerships with global academic institutions; technical advice for institutionalized capacity development.

Databases and substantive digital materials: spatial datasets, artificial intelligence-generated analyses and digital mapping materials shared with countries for Sustainable Development Goals monitoring and recovery planning; global housing compendium; Global Urban Indicators Database expanded and updated with disaggregated urban data; Global Urban Monitoring Framework strengthened through additional housing-focused indicators, enhanced metadata and interoperability with national statistical systems; collaboration and coordination with the Global Urban Data Coalition for Sustainable Development Goals and New Urban Agenda monitoring; UN-Habitat Learn platform includes approximately 25 self-paced online courses for urban practitioners and students.

Category and subcategory	2025 planned	2025 actual	2026 planned	2027 planned
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D. Communication deliverables

Outreach programmes, special events and information materials: awareness-raising events and communication materials showcasing the application of digital tools in cities and post-crisis contexts; updated catalogue of UN-Habitat online course offering mapped against the New Urban Agenda (available on UN-Habitat Learn platform); information materials, including the New Urban Agenda newsletter and the UNI initiative newsletter.

External and media relations: media and partner engagement highlighting United Nations Innovation Technology Accelerator for Cities applied research and digital innovations for sustainable and inclusive urban development.

Digital platforms and multimedia content: multimedia content on demonstrating digital tool functionalities, use cases and training materials.

Subprogramme 4 Partnerships, coalitions, advocacy and communication

Objective

- 15.70 The objective, to which this subprogramme contributes, is to advance cooperation among relevant stakeholders to ensure adequate housing, land and basic services for all.

Strategy

- 15.71 To contribute to the objective, the subprogramme will:
- (a) Build and nurture inclusive partnerships and multi-stakeholder coalitions to support coordinated approaches on housing, land and basic services;
 - (b) Convene global, regional and national advocacy platforms and facilitate stakeholder engagement, including through the World Urban Forum, World Habitat Day, World Cities Day (in the framework of the Urban October);
 - (c) Engage in advocacy and strategic communication, outreach and knowledge-sharing to raise awareness and engagement in policy action for adequate housing, land and basic services for all.
- 15.72 In doing so, the subprogramme will assist Member States in making progress towards achieving the Sustainable Development Goals, particularly Goals 1, 6, 10, 11 and 17.
- 15.73 The above-mentioned work is expected to result in:
- (a) Strategic coalitions and cooperation supporting the implementation of solutions for housing, land and basic services at the global, national and local levels;
 - (b) Improved visibility and accessibility of solutions for housing, land and basic services.

Programme performance in 2025

The Global Stakeholder Forum advances inclusive and accountable urban development

- 15.74 The subprogramme supports multi-stakeholder participation in UN-Habitat normative and intergovernmental work through the Global Stakeholder Forum as a structured platform for coordinated dialogue and consolidated stakeholder inputs, including in the lead-up to intergovernmental meetings. The subprogramme provided substantive, technical and organizational support to convene the Global Stakeholder Forum, facilitating broad-based participation from civil society, local authorities, the private sector and other partners. It coordinated stakeholder consultations, provided assistance to help consolidate key messages and recommendations and helped to ensure that these inputs were systematically channelled into UN-Habitat intergovernmental processes and normative work.
- 15.75 Progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see table 15.7).

Table 15.7
Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)
A declaration issued at the Global Stakeholder Forum in consultation with more than 200 participants on inclusive multilateralism, adequate housing, climate action and Sustainable Development Goals localization was presented to the UN-Habitat Assembly	–	A declaration from the Global Stakeholder Forum reflecting the collective voice of more than 600 participants from over 500 organizations emphasizing inclusive multilevel cooperation, sustainable urbanization and strengthened partnerships to advance Sustainable Development Goal implementation was presented to the UN-Habitat Assembly

Planned results for 2027

Result 3: the World Urban Forum is leveraged to advance global commitments to ensure adequate housing, land and basic services for all

Proposed programme plan for 2027

- 15.76 Accelerating progress on sustainable urban development benefits from strengthened global advocacy, inclusive convening and coordinated multi-stakeholder engagement. The subprogramme has reinforced the World Urban Forum as a key platform for global dialogue and stakeholder mobilization. These efforts have helped to enhance the visibility of adequate housing and sustainable urbanization priorities and solutions, strengthening collective commitment and action towards the New Urban Agenda and the Sustainable Development Goals, particularly Goal 11.

Lessons learned and planned change

- 15.77 The lesson for the subprogramme was the possibilities to further strengthen and transform broad stakeholder participation in flagship events into more structured and inclusive engagement for actionable commitments and follow-up. In applying the lesson, the subprogramme will strengthen mechanisms to capture and track stakeholder contributions and improve strategic communications to ensure that advocacy outcomes support implementation at all levels.
- 15.78 Expected progress towards the objective is presented in the performance measure below (see table 15.8).

Table 15.8
Performance measure

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)	2026 (planned)	2027 (planned)
–	–	–	Adoption of the “stakeholder-led” Baku Call to Action at the thirteenth session of the World Urban Forum	Sustained commitments, including in the areas of financing, policy reforms, strengthened partnerships, and knowledge and practices exchange, to drive the uptake, mainstreaming and

2023 (actual)	2024 (actual)	2025 (actual)	2026 (planned)	2027 (planned)
				implementation of the Baku Call to Action

Deliverables

15.79 Table 15.9 lists all deliverables of the subprogramme.

Table 15.9

Subprogramme 4: deliverables for the period 2025–2027, by category and subcategory

Category and subcategory	2025 planned	2025 actual	2026 planned	2027 planned
B. Generation and transfer of knowledge				
Seminars, workshops and training events (number of days)	–	–	–	22
1. Workshops and events with global stakeholders towards the fourteenth session of the World Urban Forum	–	–	–	20
2. Global stakeholder forums and dialogues on the UN-Habitat strategic plan for 2026–2029	–	–	–	2
Publications (number of publications)	–	–	–	1
3. Publications on the World Urban Forum	–	–	–	1
Technical materials (number of materials)	–	–	–	2
4. Technical material on operationalization of the World Urban Forum	–	–	–	1
5. Guidance on global stakeholder engagement	–	–	–	1
C. Substantive deliverables				
Consultation, advice and advocacy: advocacy and stakeholder engagement with Member States, United Nations system organizations and stakeholders to support engagement in the World Urban Forum, World Habitat Day and World Cities Day within the framework of Urban October and World Urban Forum multilevel engagements.				
Databases and substantive digital materials: structured corporate repository of partner institutions and networks, coalitions and platforms.				
D. Communication deliverables				
Outreach programmes, special events and information materials: approximately 50 events, outreach and information campaigns to raise awareness and mobilization for the World Urban Forum, World Cities Day and World Habitat Day within the framework of Urban October.				
External and media relations: media engagement and media relations activities to increase visibility of the World Urban Forum and its outcomes; media engagement and promotion of World Cities Day and World Habitat Day within the framework of Urban October; campaigning, advocacy and information materials on housing, land and basic services and sustainable urban development.				
Digital platforms and multimedia content: UN-Habitat corporate website, World Urban Forum and Urban October websites and the UN-Habitat Global Event Management System, supporting information dissemination, registration and reporting.				

Annex

Programme performance in 2025

Subprogramme 1

Reduced spatial inequality and poverty in communities across the urban-rural continuum

Deliverables

A.1 Table A.1 lists all deliverables for the subprogramme.

Table A.1

Subprogramme 1: deliverables for the period 2025–2026, by category and subcategory

<i>Category and subcategory</i>	<i>2025 planned</i>	<i>2025 actual</i>	<i>2026 planned^a</i>
B. Generation and transfer of knowledge			
Field and technical cooperation projects (number of projects)	7	13	7
1. Projects on development of national and local policies on urban heritage, historical landscape and culture	1	1	1
2. Projects on integrated urban and territorial planning and effective planning laws	6	12	6
Seminars, workshops and training events (number of days)	7	7	5
3. Training sessions on policy, planning and design, governance, legislation and finance and data collection	7	7	5 [7]
Publications (number of publications)	1	1	–
4. Global report on localizing the Sustainable Development Goals and the state of water and sanitation service providers	1	1	–
Technical materials (number of materials)	4	5	4
5. Compendium of policies, plans and good practices on urban planning, regeneration, heritage conservation and extension	1	2	1
6. Guide for land management and spatial plans for poverty reduction and spatial equality	1	1	1
7. Guidelines on the right to adequate housing and prevention of homelessness among those in vulnerable situations, including migrants	1	1	1
8. Neighbourhood planning guidelines on participation and inclusive regeneration	1	1	1

^a Reflects updated planned deliverables for 2026. Values in square brackets represent the number of planned deliverables reflected in [A/80/6 \(Sect. 15\)](#).

Subprogramme 2

Enhanced shared prosperity of cities and regions

Deliverables

A.2 Table A.2 lists all deliverables for the subprogramme.

Table A.2

Subprogramme 2: deliverables for the period 2025–2026, by category and subcategory

<i>Category and subcategory</i>	<i>2025 planned</i>	<i>2025 actual</i>	<i>2026 planned</i>
B. Generation and transfer of knowledge			
Field and technical cooperation projects (number of projects)	8	8	8
1. Projects on best practices, centres of excellence, university partnerships, prosperity indices, frontier technologies and legal and governance frameworks for sustainable, inclusive and innovative development of cities and regions	8	8	8
Seminars, workshops and training events (number of days)	6	6	6
2. Training events and workshops on frontier technologies and innovation, best practices, legal and governance frameworks and prosperity indices for sustainable urban development and implementation of the New Urban Agenda and the achievement of the Sustainable Development Goals	6	6	6
Publications (number of publications)	2	–	2
3. National cities reports	2	–	2
Technical materials (number of materials)	3	3	3
4. Technical materials on frontier technologies and innovation, best practices, legal and governance frameworks and prosperity indices for sustainable urban development and implementation of the New Urban Agenda and the achievement of the Sustainable Development Goals	3	3	3

Subprogramme 3**Strengthened climate action and improved urban environment**

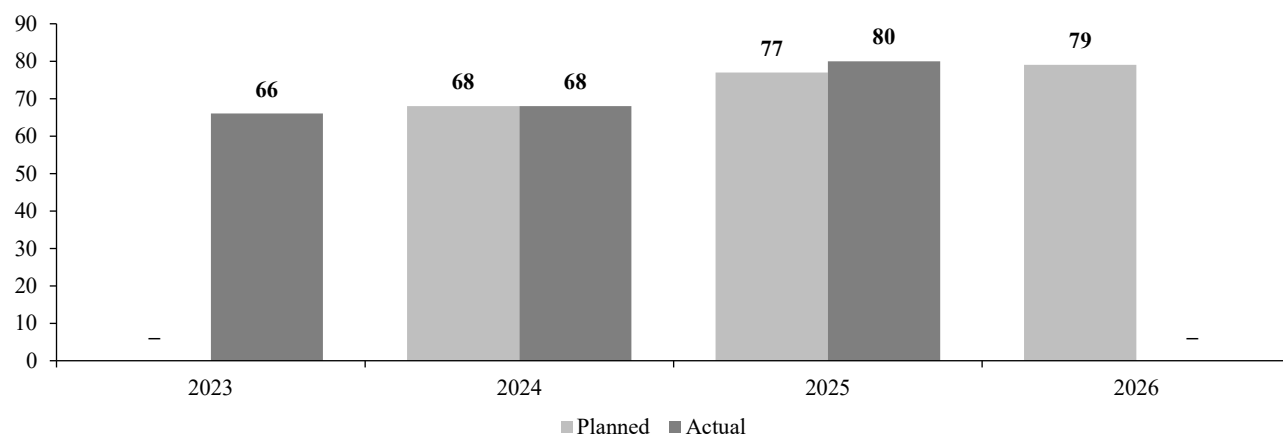
A.3 Programme performance in 2025 includes programme performance presented under results 1 and 2.

Result 1: nationally determined contributions increasingly contain urban content

A.4 The subprogramme's work contributed to strengthening the urban content of the third generation of nationally determined contributions, with 102 (80 per cent) of 128 nationally determined contributions submitted to the secretariat of the United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change in 2025, including urban content, which exceeded the planned target of 77 per cent.

A.5 The performance measure is presented below (see figure A.I).

Figure A.I

Performance measure: percentage of nationally determined contributions with urban content (cumulative)

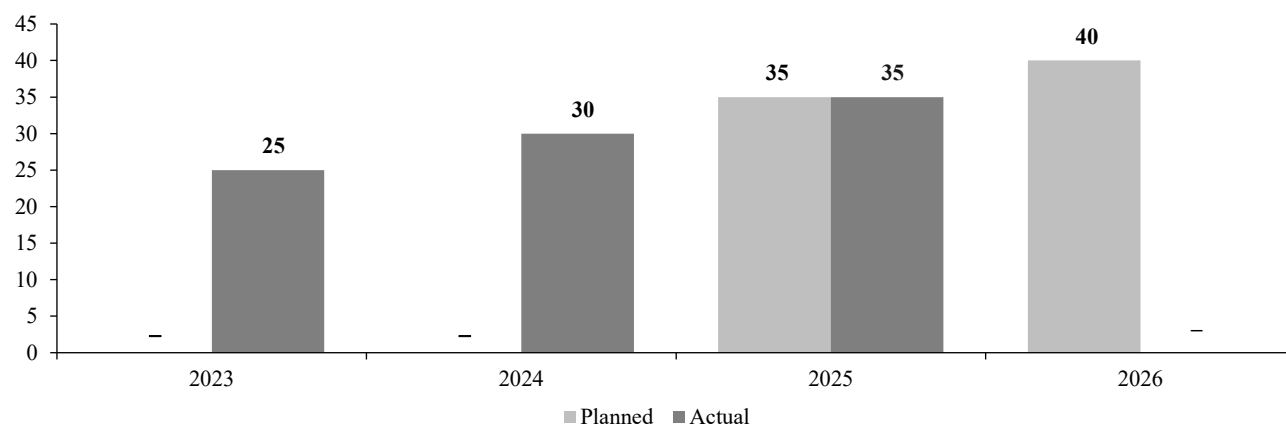
Result 2: urban climate action plans to build the resilience of the most vulnerable

A.6 The subprogramme's work contributed to the development of five additional urban climate change adaptation plans, for a total of 35, which met the planned target.

A.7 The performance measure is presented below (see figure A.II).

Figure A.II

Performance measure: number of integrated urban climate action plans developed by local and national authorities focusing on the most vulnerable (cumulative)



Deliverables

A.8 Table A.3 lists all deliverables of the subprogramme.

Table A.3

Subprogramme 3: deliverables for the period 2025–2026, by category and subcategory

Category and subcategory	2025 planned	2025 actual	2026 planned
B. Generation and transfer of knowledge			
Field and technical cooperation projects (number of projects)	37	37	45
1. Projects on improving urban air quality, the urban environment, climate change mitigation, and increased access to low-emission basic services, more sustainable infrastructure and buildings	5	5	5
2. Projects on policies, legal instruments, plans and strategies for better urban air quality, the urban environment, climate change mitigation, low-emission basic services and sustainable infrastructure and buildings	3	3	6
3. Projects on effective adaptation of communities and infrastructure to climate change, informed by participatory processes, assessments of local vulnerabilities and innovative data collection (e.g., remote sensing) and processing	18	18	20
4. Projects on policies, legal instruments, plans and strategies for strengthened resilience and effective adaptation of communities and infrastructure to climate change	5	5	6
5. Projects on urban environmental management and restoration, biodiversity protection, circular economy and ecosystem services	4	4	4
6. Projects on urban resource management and efficiency, including circular economy, efficient use of urban land, service provision and sustainable water and waste management, and promotion of cleaner energy and energy efficiency	2	2	4

Category and subcategory	2025 planned	2025 actual	2026 planned
Seminars, workshops and training events (number of days)	11	11	11
7. Training events on sustainable city models and their application, sustainable infrastructure and urban planning	6	6	6
8. Training events for national and local government partners and other urban stakeholders on urban environmental management, restoration and renovation, biodiversity protection, circular economy and ecosystem services	5	5	5
Publications (number of publications)	2	2	2
9. Publications on improved low-emission urban services and resource efficiency (e.g. focusing on technological innovation)	2	2	2
Technical materials (number of materials)	6	6	7
10. Technical materials on improved resource efficiency and protection of ecological assets, including sectoral materials	2	2	3
11. Technical materials on climate change mitigation and air quality	2	2	2
12. Technical materials on improved low-emission urban services, resource efficiency and (electric) mobility solutions and infrastructure (including monitoring)	2	2	2

Subprogramme 4 Effective urban crisis prevention and response

A.9 Programme performance in 2025 includes programme performance presented under results 1 and 2.

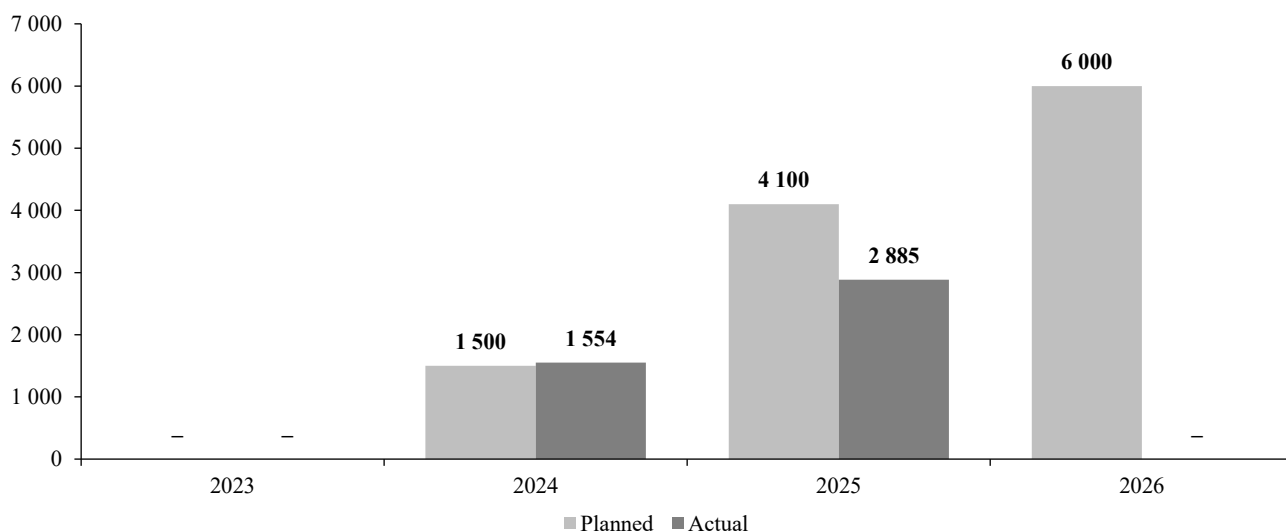
Result 1: sustainable integration of displaced communities in urban areas in Somalia

A.10 The subprogramme's work contributed to the integration of displaced communities in Somalia through the issuance of 1,331 land tenure security documents, for a total of 2,885, which did not meet the planned target of 4,100. The target was not met due to the impact of drought and a shortfall of voluntary contributions.

A.11 The performance measure is presented below (see figure A.III).

Figure A.III

Performance measure: number of land title deeds and tenure security documents issued in Somalia in support of integrating displaced communities (cumulative)



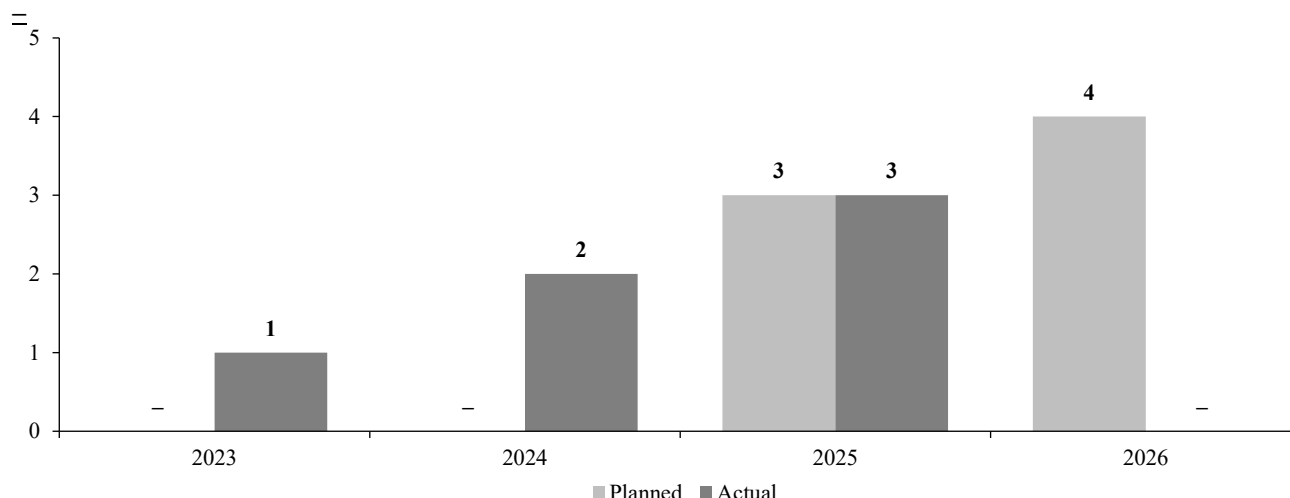
Result 2: integrated and participatory urban planning and inclusive development

A.12 The subprogramme's work contributed to one additional settlement, namely, the Gribble settlement upgrading strategy in Bosaso, Somalia, as an internally displaced persons neighbourhood plan, for a total of three settlements, which met the planned target.

A.13 The performance measure is presented below (see figure A.IV).

Figure A.IV

Performance measure: number of settlements with displaced populations adopting integrated, participatory urban planning and inclusive development approaches (cumulative)

**Deliverables**

A.14 Table A.4 lists all deliverables of the subprogramme.

Table A.4

Subprogramme 4: deliverables for the period 2025–2026, by category and subcategory

Category and subcategory	2025 planned	2025 actual	2026 planned ^a
B. Generation and transfer of knowledge			
Field and technical cooperation projects (number of projects)	22	22	22
1. Projects on enhanced social integration and cohesive communities	8	8	8
2. Projects on improved living standards and inclusion of migrants, refugees and internally displaced persons	8	8	8
3. Projects on enhanced resilience of the built environment and infrastructure	6	6	6
Seminars, workshops and training events (number of days)	31	31	30
4. Seminars, workshops and training events on enhanced social integration and cohesive communities	10	10	10
5. Seminars, workshops and training events on improved living standards and inclusion of migrants, refugees and internally displaced persons	9	9	9
6. Seminars, workshops and training events on enhanced resilience of the built environment and infrastructure	12	12	11 [12]
Publications (number of publications)	1	1	1
7. Publication on improved living standards and inclusion of migrants, refugees and internally displaced persons	1	1	1

Section 15 Human settlements

<i>Category and subcategory</i>	<i>2025 planned</i>	<i>2025 actual</i>	<i>2026 planned^a</i>
Technical materials (number of materials)	7	7	7
8. Technical materials on enhanced social integration and cohesive communities	2	2	2
9. Technical materials on improved living standards and inclusion of migrants, refugees and internally displaced persons	3	3	3
10. Technical materials on enhanced resilience of the built environment and infrastructure	2	2	2

^a Reflects updated planned deliverables for 2026. Values in square brackets represent the number of planned deliverables reflected in [A/80/6 \(Sect. 15\)](#).